

Structure- CLAUSES – DEPENDENT INDEPENDENT

A clause is a group of words with a finite verb, forming part of the sentence.

Note: the major difference between the phrase and the clause is the finite and non-finite forms of the verb. Therefore, if the verb in the expression given does not have any of the characteristics of a non-finite verb, in phrase, the expression should be considered a clause. There are two types of clauses – main or independent clause and subordinate or dependent clause.

- a. The main clause: This can stand on its own to make a complete sense or sentence e.g. I am going home now
The choir came and ministered
- b. Subordinate clause: Before the teacher arrived, the students were seriously fighting.

The three types of clauses: Noun, Adjectival / Relative and Adverbial clauses

- i. It is a group of words
- ii. It always has a finite verb
- iii. It does not express a complete thought; it needs the main clause to make it complete sense or sentence.
- iv. It only forms part of the sentence. e.g of subordinate clauses are
 - a. As soon as the boy saw the teacher, he took his heels
 - b. Unless he passes the examination, he will not travel abroad.
 - c. The landlord whose house was burgled has reported to the police
 - d. How he knew my name still remains a mystery.
 - e.

Exercise:

underline the dependent clauses

- 1. As soon as the bell rang, all the students ran to their various classes.
- 2. We bought the land which he sold.
- 3. They have not been in school since we resumed
- 4. When the police arrived, the students were seriously fighting